If control was given to Pakistan, the collateral damage wouldn't have been prevented but it would not be caused by the foreign attacks perceived to be carried out by the arbitrary and controversial decisions taken by a foreign ruler and his aide only (second arrow gone). The bombing and strafing by the Pakistan air force and army in the operations in Waziristan had caused collateral damage, but it was a battlefield for the Pakistan Army. Drone attack would be just a change in modus operandi (third arrow gone). The workable solution would be to form a committee comprising representatives of ISI, IB, CIA and the High Court, which would identify the targets and decide to launch the drone attack (fourth arrow gone). Every strike should be well considered. After a successful attack, the death of the actual target should be declared officially with the list of his crimes or accusations. In case of collateral damage, all bodies should be identified and handed over to their relatives for proper burial. The relatives of innocent victims should be compensated similar to the victims of other terrorist attacks in Pakistan. The situation would thus be reduced to four arrows, which would be the US and Pakistan against the militants and the militants against the US and Pakistan. In fact, it would be a two-against-one situation, which would mean US and Pakistan against militants.

MYTHS, CONSPIRACY THEORIES AND FACTS

In the whirlpool of accusations, myths and conspiracy theories taking place in Pakistan, two countries figured prominently: the US and India.

The US factor

The then US President Obama unveiled his security strategy on 27 March 2009, with an obvious shift in attention away from Iraq to Afghanistan, but lumped Afghanistan and Pakistan together, thus giving it an acronym 'Af-Pak Policy'. His arguments to take a unified approach to policy and strategy for these two countries were (1) the terrorists who planned and supported the 9/11 attacks were in Pakistan and Afghanistan and (2) the future of Afghanistan was inextricably linked to the future of its neighbour, Pakistan.

He specified that Al Qaeda was actively planning attacks on the United States homeland from its safe haven in Pakistan.